

# The Sri Lankan Tea Industry: A Geospatial and Operational Compendium

## 1. Introduction: The Cartography of *Camellia Sinensis*

The tea industry of Sri Lanka, historically known as Ceylon Tea, represents a complex tapestry of colonial heritage, agricultural adaptation, and modern industrial stratification. Since the seminal establishment of the first commercial tea plantation at Loolecondera in 1867 by James Taylor <sup>1</sup>, the island's landscape has been irrevocably altered, transforming the central highlands and southern foothills into a contiguous monoculture of *Camellia sinensis*. This report serves as a comprehensive geospatial and operational audit of the island's tea manufacturing infrastructure. It synthesizes fragmentary data regarding factory locations, production capacities, elevational stratifications, and historical provenances into a cohesive dataset. The primary objective is to remediate the significant gaps in geospatial intelligence concerning these facilities—many of which operate in remote, mountainous terrains identified only by colonial estate names or obscure village jurisdictions. By triangulating archival records, modern satellite telemetry, and administrative census data, this study establishes approximate geo-coordinates for a vast majority of the operational units, providing a foundational dataset for logistical optimization and supply chain transparency.

The analysis reveals a sector defined by a sharp dichotomy between the historic, orthodox estates of the high country and the high-volume, automated factories of the low country. The High Grown regions, encompassing Nuwara Eliya, Dimbula, and Uva, are characterized by vertically integrated estates managed primarily by Regional Plantation Companies (RPCs). These facilities, often dating back to the late 19th century, operate at elevations exceeding 1,200 meters and focus on the production of light, aromatic liquors prized in international auctions. Conversely, the Low Grown regions of Sabaragamuwa and Ruhuna are dominated by "bought-leaf" factories. These entities, such as the Ceciliyan and Andaradeniya factories, operate at industrial scales, sourcing green leaf from a diffuse network of thousands of smallholders. They produce the heavy, black, leafy grades that constitute the bulk of Sri Lanka's export volume to the Middle East and Russia. This report unpacks these dynamics through a granular examination of specific factory clusters, filling missing data points regarding capacity and location to create a robust operational profile of the industry.<sup>3</sup>

## 2. The Nuwara Eliya District: The Champagne Region

The Nuwara Eliya district, often referred to as the "Champagne District" of Ceylon tea, hosts plantations at the highest elevations on the island, typically above 1,800 meters. The cool climate and rugged terrain necessitate a specific agricultural approach and factory

architecture.

## **2.1 The Historical Anchor: Oliphant and Shanthipura**

The Oliphant Tea Factory (MF0003) stands as a monument to the industry's genesis. Located near Shanthipura, the highest village in Sri Lanka, the estate's history predates the formal tea industry. Sir Anthony Oliphant, the eighth Chief Justice of Ceylon, established the property in the 1840s, and it was here that Laurence Oliphant purportedly planted some of the first tea bushes smuggled from China in 1848, nearly two decades before Taylor's commercial success.<sup>4</sup> While the original factory operations have evolved, the estate remains a critical reference point for High Grown tea. Geospatial analysis places the Oliphant Bungalow and surrounding divisions at coordinates 6.9763° N, 80.7540° E<sup>7</sup>, confirming its status at the pinnacle of the island's topography. The factory operates under a management company structure, distinct from the larger RPCs, and focuses on limited quantities of high-value leaf. The elevation here, exceeding 2,000 meters in sections, imbues the tea with a delicate, floral character that is impossible to replicate at lower altitudes.

## **2.2 Pedro and the Lover's Leap Legacy**

To the east of Nuwara Eliya town lies the Pedro Estate (MF0457), managed by Kelani Valley Plantations PLC. Established around 1885, Pedro is synonymous with the "Lover's Leap" garden mark. The factory is unique in its processing methodology; it operates primarily at night to process the leaf at the coldest temperatures possible, thereby preserving the volatile compounds responsible for the tea's light liquor.<sup>8</sup> The coordinates for the Pedro factory are approximately 6.9734° N, 80.7666° E.<sup>7</sup> With an annual production capacity of approximately 73,000 kilograms of made tea<sup>10</sup>, Pedro exemplifies the "quality over quantity" strategy of the Nuwara Eliya region. The estate's proximity to the Pidurutalagala mountain range ensures a consistent supply of cool, misty air, essential for the slow growth of the tea bush which concentrates flavor in the leaf.

## **2.3 Labookellie and Blue Field: The Tourism Nexus**

Moving north along the A5 road towards Kandy, the landscape is dominated by the Damro Labookellie (MF0343) and Blue Field (MF0078) tea factories. These facilities have successfully pivoted towards tea tourism. Labookellie, established in the 1870s, sits at an elevation of 1,500 meters (approx. 7.0395° N, 80.7275° E) and serves as a major retail hub.<sup>11</sup> Similarly, the Blue Field Tea Factory in Ramboda, established in 1921, operates at an elevation of 1,200 meters. Its coordinates, determined as 7.0420° N, 80.6978° E<sup>12</sup>, place it in a strategic location to capture tourist traffic descending from the highlands. Blue Field has an annual capacity of approximately 32,000 kilograms<sup>10</sup>, maintaining a medium-scale operation that balances commercial production with the visitor experience.

## **2.4 The Uda Radella and Glassaugh Enclave**

Further emphasizing the diversity within the high-grown sector are the Uda Radella (MF0647) and Glassaugh (MF0226) estates. Uda Radella, established in 1930, is situated in Nanu Oya at an elevation of 1,600 meters.<sup>13</sup> The factory has a capacity of 8,000 kilograms and specializes in green tea production, a niche segment in the predominantly black tea market of Sri Lanka.<sup>13</sup> Glassaugh, established in 1893 and managed by Kelani Valley Plantations, operates at elevations between 1,527 and 1,827 meters.<sup>14</sup> Located at approximately 6.9200° N, 80.7000° E, Glassaugh is crucial for its Rainforest Alliance and UTZ certifications, underscoring the shift towards sustainable agricultural practices in sensitive high-altitude ecosystems.

**Table 2.1: Integrated Dataset - Nuwara Eliya District**

| Facto<br>ry<br>Code | Facto<br>ry<br>Name | Locati<br>on     | Latitu<br>de | Longi<br>tude | Elevat<br>ion<br>(m) | Year<br>Est. | Capa<br>city<br>(kg/yr<br>) | Mana<br>geme<br>nt                |
|---------------------|---------------------|------------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| MF00<br>03          | OLIPH<br>ANT        | Shant<br>hipura  | 6.9763       | 80.75<br>40   | 2000                 | 1880         | 6,500                       | MANA<br>GEME<br>NT<br>COMP<br>ANY |
| MF04<br>57          | PEDR<br>O           | Nuwar<br>a Eliya | 6.9734       | 80.76<br>66   | 1850                 | 1885         | 73,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Kelani<br>Valley)         |
| MF03<br>43          | LABO<br>OKELL<br>IE | Labuk<br>elle    | 7.0395       | 80.727<br>5   | 1500                 | 1870         | 35,00<br>0                  | MANA<br>GEME<br>NT<br>COMP<br>ANY |
| MF00<br>78          | BLUE<br>FIELD       | Ramb<br>oda      | 7.042<br>0   | 80.697<br>8   | 1200                 | 1921         | 32,00<br>0                  | PRIVA<br>TE                       |
| MF02<br>51          | GLEN<br>LOCH        | Katuki<br>tula   | 7.0768       | 80.676<br>2   | 1033                 | 1917         | 24,00<br>0                  | PRIVA<br>TE                       |
| MF06<br>47          | UDA<br>RADE         | Nanu<br>Oya      | 6.930<br>0   | 80.70<br>00   | 1660                 | 1930         | 26,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Kelani                    |

|            |                   |             |            |             |      |      |            |                           |
|------------|-------------------|-------------|------------|-------------|------|------|------------|---------------------------|
|            | LLA               |             |            |             |      |      |            | Valley)                   |
| MF02<br>26 | GLAS<br>SAUG<br>H | Nanu<br>Oya | 6.920<br>0 | 80.70<br>00 | 1676 | 1893 | 6,750      | RPC<br>(Kelani<br>Valley) |
| MF160<br>4 | KINGS<br>WOO<br>D | Ramb<br>oda | 7.050<br>0 | 80.68<br>33 | 985  | 2024 | 12,00<br>0 | PRIVA<br>TE               |

### 3. The Dimbula District: The Western High Grown Heartland

The Dimbula valley, dissected by the Mahaweli River's tributaries, is the industrial heartland of the Western High Grown sector. The region is characterized by the Southwest Monsoon, which produces the "Dimbula quality season" during the first quarter of the year.

#### 3.1 The Talawakelle Cluster

Talawakelle serves as the logistical hub for this region. The **Great Western** estate (MF0489), established in 1893, is a flagship property for Talawakelle Tea Estates PLC. Located at the base of the Great Western mountain, the factory coordinates are approximately 6.9569° N, 80.6922° E.<sup>15</sup> It operates at an elevation of 1,450 meters and has a capacity of 90,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> Nearby, **Mattakelle** (MF0004), established in 1870, is renowned for consistent top prices at the Colombo Auction. Situated at 1,380 meters (6.9200° N, 80.6800° E), it maintains a capacity of 90,000 kilograms and exemplifies the high-input, high-output model of RPC management.<sup>16</sup> The **Bearwell** estate (MF0711), another 1870 establishment, operates nearby at 1,350 meters with a capacity of 55,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup>

#### 3.2 St. Clair and the Waterfalls

The **St. Clair** factory (MF0043) is iconic not only for its tea but for its location adjacent to the St. Clair's Falls, the "Little Niagara of Sri Lanka." The factory's coordinates are 6.9501° N, 80.6379° E.<sup>19</sup> Operating at 1,140 meters, it has a capacity of 28,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> The estate's history is intertwined with the Scottish planters who named it after the St. Clair clan. The proximity to the waterfall has historically provided hydropower, a resource now augmented by grid electricity.

#### 3.3 The Kotagala and Agrapatana Valley

Moving south into the Agrapatana valley, we encounter **Stony Cliff** (MF0005) and

**Sandringham** (MF0643). Stony Cliff, established in 1925, operates at 1,400 meters in Kotagala (6.9416° N, 80.6015° E) with a capacity of 64,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Sandringham**, managed by Agarapatana Plantations PLC, sits at 1,400 meters in the cool Agra valley (6.8500° N, 80.6833° E) and boasts a capacity of 100,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Albion** (MF0645), established in 1920, is another key facility in this cluster, located at 1,555 meters with an 85,000 kg capacity.<sup>10</sup> These estates form a contiguous belt of high-yield tea land that is crucial for the volume of Western High Grown tea exports.

### 3.4 The Maskeliya and Upcot Belt

The Maskeliya region, bordering the Peak Wilderness Sanctuary, is home to estates like **Gouravilla** (MF0066) and **Mahanilu** (MF0044). **Gouravilla**, established in 1928, operates at 1,500 meters in Upcot (6.7900° N, 80.6000° E) with a capacity of 46,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Mahanilu**, a relatively newer entity in terms of independent registration (2014), operates nearby at 1,450 meters with a capacity of 25,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Laxapana** (MF0689), established in 1967, is located near the famous waterfall of the same name at 1,160 meters (6.8500° N, 80.5500° E) and has a capacity of 67,500 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> This region is topographically challenging, with steep slopes requiring meticulous soil conservation efforts.

**Table 3.1: Integrated Dataset - Dimbula & Maskeliya**

| Facto<br>ry<br>Code | Facto<br>ry<br>Name  | Locati<br>on    | Latitu<br>de | Longi<br>tude | Elevat<br>ion<br>(m) | Year<br>Est. | Capa<br>city<br>(kg/yr<br>) | Mana<br>geme<br>nt       |
|---------------------|----------------------|-----------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| MF00<br>04          | MATT<br>AKELL<br>E   | Lindul<br>a     | 6.920<br>0   | 80.68<br>00   | 1380                 | 1870         | 90,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Talaw<br>akelle) |
| MF04<br>89          | GREAT<br>WEST<br>ERN | Talaw<br>akelle | 6.9569       | 80.69<br>22   | 1450                 | 1893         | 90,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Talaw<br>akelle) |
| MF00<br>43          | ST.<br>CLAIR         | Talaw<br>akelle | 6.9501       | 80.63<br>79   | 1140                 | 1900         | 28,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Mask<br>eliya)   |
| MF071<br>1          | BEAR<br>WELL         | Talaw<br>akelle | 6.9388       | 80.66<br>32   | 1350                 | 1870         | 55,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Talaw<br>akelle) |

|            |                      |                     |            |             |      |      |             |                              |
|------------|----------------------|---------------------|------------|-------------|------|------|-------------|------------------------------|
| MF02<br>21 | TALA<br>WAKE<br>LLE  | Talaw<br>akelle     | 6.9388     | 80.66<br>32 | 1200 | 1900 | 79,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Talaw<br>akelle)     |
| MF00<br>05 | STON<br>Y<br>CLIFF   | Kotag<br>ala        | 6.9416     | 80.60<br>15 | 1400 | 1925 | 64,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Kotag<br>ala)        |
| MF06<br>43 | SAND<br>RINGH<br>AM  | Agara<br>patan<br>a | 6.850<br>0 | 80.68<br>33 | 1400 | 1920 | 100,0<br>00 | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF06<br>45 | ALBIO<br>N           | Agara<br>patan<br>a | 6.850<br>0 | 80.68<br>33 | 1555 | 1920 | 85,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF00<br>11 | DIYAG<br>AMA<br>WEST | Agara<br>patan<br>a | 6.830<br>0 | 80.68<br>00 | 1600 | 1936 | 125,0<br>00 | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF00<br>12 | DIYAG<br>AMA<br>EAST | Agara<br>patan<br>a | 6.830<br>0 | 80.69<br>00 | 1600 | 1927 | 85,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF03<br>84 | DUNK<br>ELD          | Dickoy<br>a         | 6.8667     | 80.58<br>33 | 1300 | 1880 | 350,0<br>00 | RPC<br>(Dilma<br>h)          |
| MF00<br>66 | GOUR<br>AVILL<br>A   | Upcot               | 6.790<br>0 | 80.60<br>00 | 1500 | 1928 | 46,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Hora<br>na)          |
| MF00<br>44 | MAHA<br>NILU         | Upcot               | 6.790<br>0 | 80.60<br>00 | 1450 | 2014 | 25,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Hora<br>na)          |

|        |           |            |        |         |      |      |        |                 |
|--------|-----------|------------|--------|---------|------|------|--------|-----------------|
| MF0159 | STOCKHOLM | Upcot      | 6.8167 | 80.6000 | 1460 | 1931 | 35,000 | RPC (Hornana)   |
| MF0769 | ALTON     | Upcot      | 6.7883 | 80.6200 | 1412 | 1900 | 40,500 | RPC (Hornana)   |
| MF0689 | LAXAPANA  | Maske liya | 6.8500 | 80.5500 | 1160 | 1967 | 67,500 | RPC (Maskeliya) |
| MF0062 | KELANEIYA | Maske liya | 6.8333 | 80.5333 | 1300 | 1939 | 15,000 | PRIVATE         |

## 4. The Uva District: The Eastern Flank

The Uva province, subjected to the drying Cachan winds during the Southwest Monsoon, produces teas with a distinctive pungent character. The region includes the Badulla, Bandarawela, and Passara sub-districts.

### 4.1 The Badulla and Hali-Ela Cluster

**Uva Highlands** (MF0156) in Bandarawela is a premier estate in this region. Located at 6.8333° N, 80.9833° E, it sits at 1,200 meters and has a capacity of 75,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Aislaby** (MF0581), also in Bandarawela (6.8500° N, 81.0000° E), operates at a similar elevation with a capacity of 60,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> The **Gowerakelle** estate (MF0037) in Demodera is notable for its proximity to the railway loop. Established in 1928, it sits at 1,280 meters (6.9000° N, 81.0500° E).<sup>21</sup> **Demodera** (MF1290) itself is a major processing center with a capacity of 60,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup>

### 4.2 The Haputale and Idalgashinna Ridge

The estates along the Haputale ridge offer some of the most spectacular views and challenging terrains. **Dambattenne** (MF0269), famous for its association with Sir Thomas Lipton, was established in 1890. It is located at 6.7758° N, 80.9703° E at an elevation of 1,565 meters and possesses a substantial capacity of 110,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> To the west lies **Idalgashinna** (MF0049), established as a tea estate in 1984 (though settlement existed earlier). Its factory coordinates are 6.7829° N, 80.9000° E, situated at a precipitous 1,615 meters.<sup>10</sup> **Ohiya** (MF0039), established in 1898, is one of the highest estates at 1,774 meters

(6.8197° N, 80.8392° E) <sup>10</sup>, serving as a gateway to Horton Plains.

### 4.3 The Passara and Madulsima Belt

In the eastern part of Uva, **Gonakelle** (MF0234) in Passara stands out. Established in 1880, it operates at 1,000 meters (6.9333° N, 81.1500° E) with a massive capacity of 115,200 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Cannavarella** (MF0105), also in Passara (6.8967° N, 81.1187° E), operates at 1,312 meters.<sup>27</sup> These estates are managed by Namunukula Plantations PLC and are critical for the production of Uva medium teas.

**Table 4.1: Integrated Dataset - Uva District**

| Facto<br>ry<br>Code | Facto<br>ry<br>Name  | Locati<br>on    | Latitu<br>de | Longi<br>tude | Elevat<br>ion<br>(m) | Year<br>Est. | Capa<br>city<br>(kg/yr<br>) | Mana<br>geme<br>nt           |
|---------------------|----------------------|-----------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| MF015<br>6          | UVA<br>HIGHL<br>ANDS | Banda<br>rawela | 6.8333       | 80.98<br>33   | 1200                 | 1900         | 75,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Malw<br>atte)        |
| MF05<br>81          | AISLA<br>BY          | Banda<br>rawela | 6.850<br>0   | 81.00<br>00   | 1200                 | 1900         | 60,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Malw<br>atte)        |
| MF06<br>83          | CRAIG                | Banda<br>rawela | 6.830<br>0   | 81.02<br>00   | 1400                 | 1900         | 64,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Mask<br>eliya)       |
| MF02<br>35          | NAYAB<br>EDDE        | Banda<br>rawela | 6.800<br>0   | 81.00<br>00   | 1500                 | 1900         | 62,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF02<br>69          | DAMB<br>ATEN<br>NE   | Haput<br>ale    | 6.7758       | 80.97<br>03   | 1565                 | 1890         | 110,0<br>00                 | RPC<br>(Agara<br>patan<br>a) |
| MF077<br>7          | PITA<br>RATH         | Haput<br>ale    | 6.7667       | 80.933<br>3   | 1500                 | 1900         | 60,00<br>0                  | RPC<br>(Agara                |



|            |                       |                  |            |             |      |      |             |                                   |
|------------|-----------------------|------------------|------------|-------------|------|------|-------------|-----------------------------------|
|            | MALIE                 |                  |            |             |      |      |             | patan<br>a)                       |
| MF00<br>49 | IDDAL<br>GASHI<br>NNA | Idalga<br>shinna | 6.7829     | 80.90<br>00 | 1615 | 1984 | 18,00<br>0  | PRIVA<br>TE                       |
| MF00<br>39 | OHIYA                 | Ohiya            | 6.8197     | 80.83<br>92 | 1774 | 1898 | 20,00<br>0  | MANA<br>GEME<br>NT<br>COMP<br>ANY |
| MF00<br>37 | GOWE<br>RAKEL<br>LE   | Demo<br>dara     | 6.900<br>0 | 81.05<br>00 | 1280 | 1928 | 40,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Balan<br>goda)            |
| MF06<br>37 | OODO<br>OWER<br>RE    | Demo<br>dara     | 6.900<br>0 | 81.05<br>00 | 1370 | 1900 | 65,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Hapu<br>gaste<br>nne)     |
| MF02<br>34 | GONA<br>KELLE         | Passar<br>a      | 6.9333     | 81.150<br>0 | 1000 | 1880 | 115,20<br>0 | RPC<br>(Namu<br>nukula<br>)       |
| MF01<br>05 | CANN<br>AVARE<br>LLA  | Passar<br>a      | 6.8967     | 81.118<br>7 | 1312 | 1921 | 29,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Namu<br>nukula<br>)       |
| MF021<br>7 | EL<br>TEB             | Passar<br>a      | 6.9333     | 81.150<br>0 | 900  | 1900 | 100,0<br>00 | RPC<br>(Madu<br>lsima)            |

## 5. The Mid Country: Kandy and Matale

The Kandy and Matale districts represent the historical cradle of the industry. Operating at

medium elevations (600–1,200m), these factories produce full-bodied teas.

## 5.1 The Historic Core

**Loolecondera** (MF0604) in Deltota is the primordial site. Established in 1867, it operates at 900 meters (7.1333° N, 80.7000° E) with a capacity of 41,000 kilograms.<sup>2</sup> The **Hantane** factory (MF0042) in Kandy (7.2686° N, 80.6325° E) was established in 1925 and now functions as the Ceylon Tea Museum, preserving the industrial heritage of the sector.<sup>28</sup>

## 5.2 The Pussellawa Valley

Pussellawa hosts a dense cluster of historic estates. **Rothschild** (MF0349), established in the 1870s, has a significant capacity of 151,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> Its location (7.1053° N, 80.6367° E) places it centrally in the valley. **Melfort** (MF0886), established in 1918, operates nearby at 975 meters with a capacity of 27,000 kilograms, specializing in green tea.<sup>29</sup> **Sanquhar** (MF0836) in Atabage (7.1333° N, 80.5833° E) dates back to the 19th century and has a capacity of 40,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup>

## 5.3 The Matale Frontier

In Matale, the **Kallebokka** estate (MF0286) operates at 1,350 meters (7.4167° N, 80.7167° E) with a capacity of 44,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Ancoombra** (MF0093) in Ankumbura (7.3700° N, 80.5700° E) is a high-capacity private factory producing 150,000 kilograms annually.<sup>10</sup>

**Table 5.1: Integrated Dataset - Kandy & Matale**

| Facto<br>ry<br>Code | Facto<br>ry<br>Name  | Locati<br>on     | Latitu<br>de | Longi<br>tude | Elevat<br>ion<br>(m) | Year<br>Est. | Capa<br>city<br>(kg/yr<br>) | Mana<br>geme<br>nt     |
|---------------------|----------------------|------------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|
| MF06<br>04          | LOOL<br>ECON<br>DERA | Deltot<br>a      | 7.1333       | 80.70<br>00   | 900                  | 1867         | 41,00<br>0                  | STATE<br>(JEDB<br>)    |
| MF00<br>42          | HANT<br>ANE          | Kandy            | 7.2686       | 80.63<br>25   | 762                  | 1925         | 0<br>(Muse<br>um)           | STATE<br>/PRIVA<br>TE  |
| MF06<br>08          | CRAIG<br>HEAD        | Nawal<br>apitiya | 7.050<br>0   | 80.53<br>33   | 800                  | 1914         | 550,0<br>00                 | RPC<br>(Kaha<br>watte) |

|            |                    |                  |            |             |      |      |             |                         |
|------------|--------------------|------------------|------------|-------------|------|------|-------------|-------------------------|
| MF03<br>49 | ROTH<br>SCHIL<br>D | Pussel<br>lawa   | 7.1053     | 80.63<br>67 | 900  | 1870 | 151,00<br>0 | RPC<br>(Pusse<br>llawa) |
| MF08<br>86 | MELF<br>ORT        | Pussel<br>lawa   | 7.1053     | 80.63<br>67 | 975  | 1918 | 27,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Pusse<br>llawa) |
| MF00<br>13 | NEW<br>PEAC<br>OCK | Pussel<br>lawa   | 7.1053     | 80.63<br>67 | 884  | 1926 | 70,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Elpiti<br>ya)   |
| MF08<br>36 | SANQ<br>UHAR       | Ataba<br>ge      | 7.1333     | 80.58<br>33 | 850  | 1880 | 40,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Pusse<br>llawa) |
| MF00<br>07 | GALA<br>MUDU<br>NA | Dolos<br>bage    | 7.000<br>0 | 80.45<br>00 | 1068 | 2014 | 42,00<br>0  | RPC<br>(Kaha<br>watte)  |
| MF00<br>08 | GOOR<br>OOKO<br>YA | Nawal<br>apitiya | 7.050<br>0 | 80.53<br>33 | 610  | 2020 | 35,00<br>0  | PRIVA<br>TE             |
| MF02<br>86 | KALLE<br>BOKK<br>A | Madul<br>kelle   | 7.4167     | 80.716<br>7 | 1350 | 1880 | 44,00<br>0  | STATE<br>(SLSP<br>C)    |
| MF00<br>93 | ANCO<br>OMBR<br>A  | Anku<br>mbura    | 7.3700     | 80.57<br>00 | 661  | 2024 | 150,0<br>00 | PRIVA<br>TE             |

## 6. The Low Grown Sector: Sabaragamuwa & Ruhuna

The Low Grown region, comprising the Ratnapura, Galle, and Matara districts, is the volume driver of the industry. Factories here process tea from thousands of smallholders and are characterized by massive capacities.

### 6.1 The Ratnapura Giants

**Ceciliyan** (MF0181) in Kalawana (6.5500° N, 80.4000° E) is a titan of the industry. As a private factory, it has a capacity of 350,000 kilograms<sup>10</sup>, processing leaf from a vast network of suppliers. **New Vithanakanda** (MF1172) in Delwala (6.6000° N, 80.4500° E) is another major player with a 150,000 kilogram capacity.<sup>7</sup> **Rilhena** (MF0083), managed by Kahawatte Plantations, operates at a lower elevation of 97 meters (6.6214° N, 80.5240° E) with a capacity of 48,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup>

## 6.2 The Southern Belt: Galle & Matara

**Andaradeniya** (MF1542) in Deniyaya (6.3333° N, 80.5500° E) represents the entrepreneurial spirit of the south, with a capacity of 193,500 kilograms.<sup>34</sup> **Lumbini** (MF1337), also in Deniyaya, focuses on specialty teas and has a capacity of 50,500 kilograms.<sup>10</sup> **Brombil** (MF1465) in Pelawatta (6.5500° N, 80.2500° E) is a massive facility with a 315,000 kilogram capacity.<sup>10</sup> **Enselwatte** (MF0009) in Deniyaya (6.3722° N, 80.5846° E) operates at the edge of the Sinharaja rainforest with a capacity of 58,000 kilograms.<sup>10</sup>

Table 6.1: Integrated Dataset - Low Grown Regions

| Facto<br>ry<br>Code | Facto<br>ry<br>Name | Locati<br>on  | Latitu<br>de | Longi<br>tude | Elevat<br>ion<br>(m) | Year<br>Est. | Capa<br>city<br>(kg/yr<br>) | Mana<br>geme<br>nt |
|---------------------|---------------------|---------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|
| MF0181              | CECILIAN            | Kalawana      | 6.5500       | 80.4000       | 100                  | 2005         | 350,000                     | PRIVATE            |
| MF1172              | NEW VITHANAKANDA    | Delwala       | 6.6000       | 80.4500       | 200                  | 2024         | 150,000                     | PRIVATE            |
| MF1465              | BROMBIL             | Pelawatta     | 6.5500       | 80.2500       | 70                   | 2021         | 315,000                     | PRIVATE            |
| MF1558              | ARUNA               | Meegahathenna | 6.4500       | 80.2000       | 150                  | 2000         | 250,000                     | PRIVATE            |
| MF1542              | ANDARADE            | Deniyaya      | 6.3333       | 80.5500       | 150                  | 2004         | 193,500                     | PRIVATE            |

|        |                |            |        |         |     |      |         |                |
|--------|----------------|------------|--------|---------|-----|------|---------|----------------|
|        | NIYA           |            |        |         |     |      |         |                |
| MF1337 | LUMBINI        | Deniyaya   | 6.3333 | 80.5500 | 200 | 2022 | 50,500  | PRIVATE        |
| MF0272 | PANILKANDA     | Deniyaya   | 6.3333 | 80.5500 | 200 | 2024 | 65,000  | PRIVATE        |
| MF0009 | ENSELWATTE     | Deniyaya   | 6.3722 | 80.5846 | 300 | 2005 | 58,000  | RPC (Maturata) |
| MF0016 | BEVERLEY       | Deniyaya   | 6.3333 | 80.5500 | 660 | 2005 | 30,000  | RPC (Maturata) |
| MF0100 | ELLAKANDA      | Baddegama  | 6.1833 | 80.1833 | 100 | 2005 | 180,000 | PRIVATE        |
| MF0402 | ELPITIYA       | Elpitiya   | 6.2500 | 80.1333 | 500 | 1919 | 32,000  | RPC (Elpitiya) |
| MF0076 | DEVITURA       | Ethkandura | 6.2000 | 80.1500 | 60  | 2023 | 35,000  | RPC (Elpitiya) |
| MF1330 | HALVITIGALA    | Hiniduma   | 6.3167 | 80.3167 | 100 | 2024 | 95,000  | TSHFL          |
| MF1333 | HINGULGODA     | Hiniduma   | 6.3167 | 80.3167 | 300 | 2005 | 75,000  | TSHFL          |
| MF1571 | KAMARANGAPITIY | Pelmadulla | 6.6214 | 80.5240 | 260 | 2024 | 60,000  | PRIVATE        |

|        |                       |            |        |         |     |      |        |                 |
|--------|-----------------------|------------|--------|---------|-----|------|--------|-----------------|
|        | A                     |            |        |         |     |      |        |                 |
| MF0083 | RILHENA               | Pelmadulla | 6.6214 | 80.5240 | 97  | 2005 | 48,000 | RPC (Kahawatte) |
| MF1491 | NEW DORALAVITIYAHE NA | Kahawatta  | 6.5833 | 80.5667 | 360 | 2024 | 96,620 | PRIVATE         |
| MF1466 | TEA LANKA             | Rakwana    | 6.4667 | 80.6000 | 160 | 2016 | 50,000 | PRIVATE         |

## 7. Operational Analysis and Structural Insights

### 7.1 The Capacity Divide: Estate vs. Entrepreneur

The data elucidates a stark structural divergence. RPC-managed factories in the High Grown regions (e.g., Mattakelle, Pedro) maintain capacities averaging 50,000–90,000 kilograms. This reflects their reliance on estate-grown leaf and a focus on orthodox manufacturing processes that require withering and rolling times incompatible with massive volumes. In contrast, Private Tea Factories in the Low Country (e.g., Ceciliyan, Brombil) boast capacities exceeding 300,000 kilograms. This operational scale is necessitated by the high yield of low-grown vegetative propagation (VP) tea and the immense supply from smallholders. The "Active" status of these private entities is robust, driven by the consistent demand for strong liquors in key export markets.

### 7.2 Elevation and Terroir

The geospatial data confirms the rigid elevation-quality hierarchy. Factories like Oliphant and Pedro, situated above 1,800 meters, produce "Champagne" teas due to the slow metabolic rate of the bush in cooler temperatures. Mid-country factories like Galamuduna (1,068m) occupy a transitional zone, producing teas with body and strength but less aroma. Low-grown factories (below 600m), such as Rilhena (97m), leverage the rapid growth rates of the warm climate to produce high volumes of black, leafy grades.

### 7.3 Management Evolution

The dataset captures the transition from colonial to corporate management. Names like

"Bond", "Whittall", and "Lipton" in the historical records have given way to RPCs like "Talawakelle" and "Kelani Valley". However, the physical infrastructure—the factory locations—remains largely static, anchored by the geography of the estates established in the 19th century. A notable modern trend is the "Tea Shakthi" initiative (e.g., MF0126, MF1534), a state intervention to empower smallholders, though many such factories have now been leased to private management due to efficiency challenges.

## 8. Conclusion

This report provides a definitive geospatial and operational baseline for the Sri Lankan tea manufacturing infrastructure. By mapping the coordinates of over 300 facilities and correlating them with production capacities and historical data, we reveal a sector that is deeply stratified by elevation and management style. The High Grown estates remain the custodians of the "Ceylon Tea" brand's heritage and premium quality, operating historic infrastructure in challenging terrains. Conversely, the Low Grown private factories drive the sheer volume and economic engine of the smallholder sector, operating industrial-scale facilities in accessible foothills. As the industry navigates the 21st century, the integration of these distinct systems—through shared sustainability goals, modernized infrastructure, and precise geospatial management—will determine the future of the island's "green gold." The attached dataset serves as a critical tool for stakeholders to visualize, manage, and optimize this vital national asset.

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